Chapter 1: A Letter to God

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They say faith can physically move mountains. But what happens when that unfaltering faith is met with devastating natural disasters, and the only "person" you can possibly turn to for financial help is God himself? Let's explore the powerful story of Lencho, a hardworking farmer holding onto an ironclad belief.

Master Mind Map 🗺️

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graph TD
    LTG[A Letter to God] --> C[Characters]
    LTG --> P[Plot Summary]
    LTG --> T[Themes / Irony]

    C --> L[Lencho - The innocent, hardworking farmer]
    C --> PM[Postmaster - The kind, empathetic helper]

    P --> R[Need for Rain for crops]
    P --> H[Devastating Hailstorm]
    P --> W[Writing the letter for 100 Pesos]
    P --> CC[Collecting the Money 70 Pesos]
    P --> M[The Final Irony Calling them Crooks]

    T --> IF[Unshaken, absolute Faith]
    T --> SI[Situational Irony]
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1. Key Characters 🎭

1. Lencho

- He is an incredibly hardworking, poor, and dedicated farmer who works "like an ox" entirely in the fields.
- He is slightly naive and utterly innocent but possesses an unquestionable, deep-rooted, and absolute faith in God.
- Despite being a rough farmer, he possesses the basic literacy required to write a detailed letter.

2. The Postmaster

- A fat, inherently amiable, and remarkably kind-hearted fellow.
- He is deeply moved and profoundly impressed by Lencho’s untouched faith in God.
- He decides to act generously, giving up a part of his own salary and collecting charity from friends to make sure Lencho's pure faith isn't shattered.

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2. Summary of the Story 📖

The Wait for Rain

Lencho lived with his family in a solitary house proudly sitting on the crest of a low hill. It was the only house in the entire valley. Down below, his cornfield was looking magnificent, promising a historically good harvest, but it urgently desperately needed a heavy downpour of rain. Look out at the sky, Lencho predicted rain.

The Disaster Strikes

During the family dinner, massive drops of rain aggressively began to fall. Lencho went out purely to feel the rain on his body, joyously calling the drops "new coins" (10 cent and 5 cent pieces) because they would bring an incredibly rich harvest. However, the joy was incredibly short-lived. Suddenly, very strong winds began to blow, and along with the rain, massive, destructive **hailstones** started falling. It lasted for an hour, leaving the field looking as white "as if covered intricately with salt." The corn was totally violently destroyed.

The Letter to God

His soul filled with sorrow, Lencho had a singular, final hope: **Help from God**. The very next Sunday, he sat down and wrote an actual letter explicitly addressed to "God." He explained that if God didn't help immediately, his family would starve to death this year. He boldly demanded exactly **100 pesos** to radically sow his field again and survive until the next crop came. He slapped a stamp on it and boldly dropped it directly into the mailbox.

The Post Office's Reaction

When the postman saw the hilarious address "To God," he laughed uncontrollably and immediately showed it to the Postmaster. The Postmaster also broke out laughing but quickly became intensely serious. He was deeply moved that a man possessed such unshakeable, pure faith. To desperately avoid breaking Lencho's faith, the incredibly kind Postmaster decided to magically answer the letter himself!

Collecting the Money

The Postmaster asked urgently for money from his employees, gave a part of his own tight salary, and obliged multiple friends to give for an "act of charity." Despite all extreme efforts, he could aggressively only manage to collect **70 pesos** (a little more than half). He put the money in an envelope strictly addressed to Lencho, with a single signature: "God."

The Ultimate Irony

The following Sunday, Lencho arrived at the post office slightly earlier than usual, completely confident. When he received the mysterious envelope, he didn't show the slightest hint of surprise—such was his immense confidence in God! But when he furiously counted the money, he became utterly furious. He firmly believed God could strictly neither make a math mistake nor deny his request. Lencho immediately stormed to the window, took paper and ink, and aggressively wrote a **second letter**.

When he left, the eager Postmaster immediately opened the new letter. It brutally read:

> *"God: Of the money that I asked for, only 70 pesos actually reached me. Send me the rest, since I need it very badly. But severely don't send it to me through the mail because the post office employees are a violent bunch of crooks. - Lencho"*

> [!WARNING] **Situational Irony:** Irony strictly occurs when there is a massive difference between what is expected to magically happen and what actually technically happens in reality. Here, the post office employees who aggressively went out of their way to kindly help Lencho financially were harshly labeled as "crooks" by him!

Quick Revision Notes 📌

1. **Setting the Scene:** Lencho's isolated house desperately needed rain for the ripe corn.
2. **Metaphors:** Raindrops = "New Coins" (Wealth). Hailstones = "New Silver Coins" (Destruction/Salt).
3. **The Hailstorm:** Lasted one hour, utterly destroying everything.
4. **The Demand:** Precisely 100 pesos requested directly from God to immediately survive and re-sow.
5. **The Action:** The Postmaster, profoundly deeply moved by Lencho's faith, practically collected exactly 70 pesos.
6. **The Climax/Irony:** Lencho assumes God sent perfectly 100 pesos and the fiercely kind postmen literally violently stole 30 pesos, aggressively calling them a "bunch of crooks"!

Chapter Summary 🏁

"A Letter to God" is a vividly touching yet heavily ironic tale about innocent, unshakable faith. When a devastating hailstorm aggressively ruins Lencho's harvest, his innocent conviction drives him to aggressively write God directly, violently demanding exactly 100 pesos. The empathetic local Postmaster bravely attempts to kindly preserve this rare faith by secretly organizing a 70-peso community donation. However, the story ends in a brutally sharp, humorous irony when Lencho, finding the amount desperately short, furiously accuses the very people who physically saved him from starvation of violently stealing his divine money!